STANDATA bulletin 23-BCB-008/25-GCB-002

Building/Gas

Access to roof-mounted HVAC equipment

Date Issued: June 2026

Purpose

To provide guidance for access to roof-mounted HVAC equipment systems installed in compliance with the National Building Code – 2023 Alberta Edition (NBC(AE)) and the references from CSA B149.1:25 Natural gas and propane installation code (CSA B149.1:25). The NBC(AE) 1st printing currently references the B149.1:20 edition.

Discussion

Stakeholders such as Building Safety Codes Officers, designers and contractors have indicated when applying Article 3.6.4.7. of the NBC(AE) for access to roof-mounted HVAC equipment, they may not have a readily available CSA B149.1:25 . Resulting in confusion and inconsistent application of these code provisions across the province. Incorporating the relevant information into one document is intended to assist the code users in facilitating compliance with the provisions for access to roof-mounted HVAC equipment. The CSA B149.1:25 came into force on March 1, 2026.

Code References

NBC(AE) Division B, Article 3.6.4.7.

3.6.4.7. Access to Roof-Mounted HVAC Equipment
1) A *building* shall be provided with access to the roof in conformance with Clauses 4.14.5 and 4.14.6 of CSA B149.1, “Natural gas and propane installation code,” if heating, ventilating or air-conditioning equipment is installed on the roof.
2) Fixed access shall be provided to rooftop heating, ventilating or air-conditioning equipment that is installed on a sloped roof.

NBC(AE) Division B, Sentence 6.2.1.6.(4)

6.2.1.6. Installation – General
4) Access to roof-mounted heating, ventilating or air-conditioning equipment shall be provided in conformance with Article 3.6.4.7.

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NBC(AE) Division B, Article 9.33.1.2

9.33.1.2. Access to Roof-Mounted HVAC Equipment
1) Provisions for access to roof-mounted heating, ventilating and air-conditioning equipment shall conform to the requirements of Article 3.6.4.7.

CSA B149.1 Natural gas and propane installation code

Clause 4.14.5

4.14.5 Roof access
An appliance shall not be installed on a roof
a) exceeding 13 ft (4 m) in height from grade to roof elevation unless fixed access to the roof is provided; and
b) exceeding 26 ft (8 m) in height from grade to roof elevation unless permanent fixed access to the roof by means of either a stairway or a stairway leading to a ladder not exceeding 13 ft (4 m) in height is provided.

Clause 4.14.6

4.14.6 Roof installation clearances
When an appliance is installed on a roof
a) the appliance shall be installed on a well-drained surface. When water stands on the roof, either at the appliance or in the passageways to the appliance, or when the roof is sloped or has a water seal, a suitable anti-skid walkway shall be provided. Such a walkway shall be located adjacent to the appliance and control panels, and when the appliance is located on a sloped roof, the walkway shall extend from the appliance to the point of access and be equipped with guardrails so that the appliance can be safely accessed and serviced;
b) the clearance between the appliance and the edge of the roof or other hazard shall be at least 6 ft (2 m); and
c) if the appliance is enclosed, such an enclosure shall permit easy entry and movement, be of reasonable height, and have at least 2 ft (600 mm) clearance on either side of the service access panel of each appliance in the enclosure.

Source: Clauses 4.14.5 and 4.14.6 **CSA B149.1:25, *Natural gas and propane installation code.***
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Unless stated otherwise, all Code references in this STANDATA are to Division B of the National Building Code – 2023 Alberta Edition or the CSA B149.1:25 Natural gas and propane installation code.

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